

The Forty-Year Framing and Reframing Guide

A Deep Field Manual for Solar Consultations

Based on the original Nova Structa closer playbook, rewritten as an ethical, practical, and advanced guide to controlling meaning, creating clarity, and leading decisions without pressure.

Read This First

Framing is not magic language. It is the discipline of helping a homeowner understand what a conversation means before they decide what the facts mean. Reframing is the discipline of changing an unhelpful meaning into a more accurate, useful, and decision-ready meaning.

A weak closer tries to win the argument. A strong closer wins the context. The homeowner says, "It costs too much," and the weak closer argues price. The strong closer asks, "Compared to what?" That question changes the frame from price to comparison. The homeowner says, "I need to think about it," and the weak closer pushes. The strong closer reframes it as, "That usually means something is still unclear. What part would you want to feel better about before making a decision?"

Ethical rule: never use framing to hide facts, invent urgency, exaggerate savings, or pressure a signature. Use framing to make the true comparison clear.

The Master Definition

A frame is the mental container around the conversation. It tells the homeowner what role they are in, what role you are in, what problem is being solved, what information matters, and what the next step means.

A reframe changes the container. It does not deny what the homeowner said. It honors the concern and places it in a better context.

Simple formula

Frame = "Here is what this means."

Reframe = "That makes sense. Another way to look at it is..."

If you master only one idea, master this: people rarely respond to facts alone. They respond to the meaning attached to those facts. Your job is to attach honest, useful meaning.

The Five Layers of Every Frame

1. Identity

Who is the homeowner being invited to be? A confused shopper? A smart homeowner? A responsible parent? A person with options? A person who owns instead of rents? Identity frames are powerful because people act consistently with who they believe they are.

Example: "You are doing what a smart homeowner should do: comparing the option before the utility bill keeps climbing."

2. Context

What is this conversation about? If the context is "a salesperson came to sell me panels," resistance rises. If the context is "we are checking whether the house qualifies for a lower, more predictable energy option," curiosity rises.

Example: "Today is not about forcing anything. It is about seeing whether the numbers and the house qualify."

3. Criteria

What standards decide the outcome? If the homeowner uses only monthly price, you may lose to confusion. If the criteria are total cost, predictability, ownership, incentives, utility trends, and comfort, the decision becomes more complete.

Example: "The question is not just, 'What is the payment?' The question is, 'Is this better than staying with the utility over time?'"

4. Contrast

What are they comparing against? Most objections are bad comparisons. "Solar is expensive" compared to doing nothing. But doing nothing is not free. It is a continuing utility bill with rate uncertainty and no ownership.

Example: "Totally fair. Let us compare solar against the bill you are already committed to paying, not against zero."

5. Next Action

What does the next step mean? A signature can feel like danger if framed as a trap. It can feel normal if framed as the step that allows engineering, permitting, and utility review to begin, subject to the actual agreement terms.

Example: "This step starts the formal process. I want you to understand it before you tap anything."

The Frame Stack for the Original Consultation

The original playbook has a useful sequence: control, connect, clarify, credibility, pain, solution, objections, close. The advanced version is to understand the hidden frame behind each step.

1. Door / Entry Frame: "I am safe, normal, and professional."

Before you can persuade, the homeowner must feel physically and socially comfortable. Your first thirty seconds should lower threat, not raise intensity. Smile. Ask about shoes. Acknowledge the room. Be easy to be around.

"Hey, you must be [Name]. Good to meet you. Should I take my shoes off, or are we good?"

2. Relationship Frame: "This is a human conversation."

The purpose of rapport is not random small talk. It is emotional orientation. You are showing that you see them as people, not as a commission. Rapport should be real, quick, and respectful.

"I like this setup. This looks like the comfortable room everyone ends up in."

3. Process Frame: "There is a simple path."

People relax when they know the map. Tell them what will happen before it happens. This reduces surprise and prevents them from interrupting with questions at the wrong time.

"I will keep this simple. First I check the energy usage and equipment, then I explain the program, then we compare numbers. If it makes sense, we talk next steps. If it does not, no pressure."

4. Qualification Frame: "The program must approve the home; I do not decide by opinion."

This frame protects trust. You are not begging them to buy. You are helping determine fit. Qualification also makes the conversation feel like an evaluation instead of a pitch.

"The application and home details determine what is possible. My job is to help you understand the option and see if you qualify."

5. Utility Frame: "Doing nothing is still a decision."

The central reframe in solar is that staying with the utility is not neutral. It is an ongoing payment path. You must make the current path visible without exaggeration.

"The current option is simple: keep paying the utility with no fixed end date. The only question is whether there is a better option for this house."

6. Ownership Frame: "Renting power versus controlling more of it."

Homeowners understand ownership. Connect the energy decision to the same logic that made them buy a home instead of rent, while staying accurate about financing, equipment, and program terms.

"You bought the home because ownership gave you more control. Energy is similar: the question is whether it makes sense to keep renting power every month or move toward more control."

7. Discovery Frame: "Concerns are welcome."

Most salespeople fear objections. Masters invite them. The frame is: concerns do not block the close; hidden concerns block the close. If the homeowner trusts you enough to object, the deal is still alive.

"I actually want every concern on the table. It is easier to make a good decision when nothing is hiding in the background."

8. Decision Frame: "If the numbers work and concerns are handled, the next step is normal."

The close should not feel like a sudden ambush. It should feel like the natural end of a well-framed process.

"If the house qualifies, the numbers are lower, and the concerns are clear, would moving forward make sense?"

The Four Stages of Framing

1. Pre-frame

A pre-frame is the meaning you install before the sensitive part of the conversation. It prevents resistance before it appears.

Before asking financial questions: "I am going to ask a few basic questions so the system can check eligibility. If something does not apply, just tell me."

2. In-frame

An in-frame is the meaning you maintain while the conversation is happening. It keeps the homeowner oriented and prevents the conversation from scattering.

"We are still in the question-gathering part. I will answer this fully, and then we will compare the numbers."

3. Reframe

A reframe is used when the homeowner gives a concern, assumption, or emotional reaction that points the conversation in the wrong direction.

Homeowner: "I do not want another bill." Reframe: "I get that. The goal is not to add a bill. The goal is to replace a bill you already have with something lower and more predictable, if the numbers work."

4. Post-frame

A post-frame defines what just happened and what happens next. It prevents buyer anxiety after a decision.

"Good. The important thing is that you understood the numbers, saw the comparison, and chose the next step. Now the site survey confirms the final design details."

The Golden Sequence: Agree, Clarify, Reframe, Advance

When a homeowner objects, do not snap back with an answer. Use this four-part sequence.

1. Agree

Agreement does not mean the objection is correct. It means the concern is understandable.

"That is a fair question."

2. Clarify

Find out what the concern actually means. The first objection is often a headline, not the real issue.

"When you say it feels expensive, do you mean the monthly payment, the total amount, or just the idea of financing something new?"

3. Reframe

Place the concern in the correct comparison.

"That makes sense. The comparison I would use is not solar versus no payment. It is solar versus the utility payment you are already making."

4. Advance

Ask a small next question to test whether the concern is resolved.

"If the monthly number is lower than what you are already paying, does that part feel better?"

The Difference Between Pressure and Leadership

Pressure says, "Do this because I need you to." Leadership says, "Here is the map, here is the comparison, here is the consequence of each option, and here is the next reasonable step."

Pressure creates resistance. Leadership creates certainty. Pressure speeds up the salesperson. Leadership slows down the homeowner just enough to think clearly.

Pressure language to avoid

- "You have to do this today."
- "Everybody is doing it."
- "You would be crazy not to."
- "This is free."
- "Do not worry about the paperwork; just sign."

Leadership language to use

- "Let us compare the options clearly."
- "If it does not make sense, we will say that."
- "I want you comfortable before moving forward."
- "Here is what this step means."
- "What part would you want clarified before deciding?"

The Twelve Master Frames

1. The Safety Frame

Purpose: reduce defensiveness. Use it early and whenever the homeowner looks uncertain.

"There is no pressure here. The only goal is to see whether this makes sense for your home."

2. The Agenda Frame

Purpose: prevent chaos. A homeowner who does not know the structure will create their own structure.

"Three steps: look at usage, explain the program, compare numbers."

3. The Expert Guide Frame

Purpose: position yourself as a guide, not a pushy seller. You are not above the homeowner; you are responsible for the process.

"I will walk you through it in plain English, and you can stop me anytime."

4. The Diagnostic Frame

Purpose: make questions feel normal. You are diagnosing fit, not interrogating.

"These questions help the system determine what your home may qualify for."

5. The Status Quo Frame

Purpose: reveal that doing nothing has a cost. This is the most important economic frame in solar.

"Keeping things the same means continuing with the utility bill as it is, including future changes."

6. The Comparison Frame

Purpose: stop isolated price judgment. Every price is judged against something.

"Let us compare monthly to monthly, predictability to predictability, and long-term value to long-term value."

7. The Ownership Frame

Purpose: connect solar to an idea homeowners already value.

"You chose ownership with the house. This is about seeing whether more control over energy also makes sense."

8. The Qualification Frame

Purpose: create honest scarcity without fake urgency. Not every house, roof, credit profile, or usage pattern qualifies.

"The first question is not whether you buy. The first question is whether the home qualifies."

9. The Transparency Frame

Purpose: build trust by naming the parts people usually fear: cost, contract, credit, roof, timeline, and cancellation terms.

"I am going to explain the good parts and the important details so there are no surprises."

10. The Objection Frame

Purpose: make objections collaborative.

"Concerns are not a problem. They are how we make sure the decision is clean."

11. The Decision Frame

Purpose: prevent endless thinking after clarity is reached.

"If the concerns are handled and the numbers are better, then the decision is really whether you want the better option or the current one."

12. The Comfort Frame

Purpose: protect the homeowner and the deal after the close. A rushed signature can become a cancellation. Comfort creates durability.

"Before you sign, tell me what this means in your own words so I know I explained it clearly."

Reframing Common Solar Objections

Objection: "I need to think about it."

Do not attack this. Thinking is reasonable. The reframe is that thinking usually means there is an unresolved question, unclear comparison, or emotional discomfort.

Weak response: "What is there to think about?"

Master response: "Of course. Usually when someone says that, it means one part is still unclear. Is it the price, the contract, the roof, the timeline, or just the idea of making the decision today?"

Advance: "If we clear that part up and the numbers still make sense, would you be comfortable taking the next step?"

Objection: "It is too expensive."

Expensive compared to what? That is the key. Never let price float alone in the air. Anchor it to the current utility cost and future uncertainty.

"I understand. Let us compare it to what you are already paying. If solar is higher, we should not do it. If it is lower and more predictable, then it is not an added expense; it is a replacement option."

Objection: "I do not want another bill."

This is often the cleanest reframe in the entire sale.

"I agree. Nobody wants another bill. The goal is not to add one. The goal is to reduce or replace the one you already have with a better structure, if you qualify."

Objection: "Just send me information."

This usually means the homeowner wants distance from pressure. Reframe information as something that only becomes useful after you know their numbers.

"I can send information, but generic information will not tell you whether your home qualifies or whether the numbers are lower. Let us finish the comparison first, then I can send you the exact summary."

Objection: "I want to get more quotes."

Do not insult shopping. Reframe it around comparing the right things.

"That is smart. If you compare, make sure you compare the same equipment class, warranty, production estimate, financing terms, dealer fees, roof work, utility process, and monthly outcome. If you only compare the headline price, it can be misleading."

Objection: "My spouse is not here."

Never minimize the missing decision-maker. Reframe the current conversation as preparation, not exclusion.

"That makes sense. A decision like this should include both of you. Let us make sure you understand the option clearly, then we can either bring them in by phone or schedule a time when you are both present."

Objection: "I do not trust solar."

This is not a product objection. It is a trust and evidence objection. Reframe from belief to verification.

"Fair. You should not trust a concept blindly. Let us verify the parts that matter: production estimate, warranty, payment, utility process, roof impact, and what happens if the numbers do not work."

Objection: "Is this free?"

Be extremely careful. Do not call financed solar free. Reframe free to upfront cost, if accurate.

"Not free. The accurate way to say it is that there may be no upfront out-of-pocket cost if you qualify. You would still have a payment or program terms, and we compare that against your current utility bill."

Objection: "It sounds too good to be true."

This is a trust signal. Slow down and reframe around details.

"That is a healthy reaction. Let us go through the exact numbers and terms. If anything does not make sense, we should stop."

Objection: "What if I move?"

Reframe from fear to exit options, but do not overpromise. Explain the actual transfer, payoff, or assumption options based on the agreement.

"Good question. The answer depends on the financing and contract terms. Let us look at the exact options: transfer, payoff, or how it is handled during sale. I do not want to guess on that."

Objection: "What about my roof?"

Roof concerns are valid. Reframe solar as dependent on roof suitability, not blind installation.

"The roof has to make sense first. That is why the site survey and engineering review matter. If the roof is not a fit, we address that before moving forward."

Objection: "What if the panels do not produce enough?"

Reframe to design, production estimate, monitoring, warranty, and utility rules.

"That is exactly why the production estimate matters. We look at usage, roof angle, shading, system size, and the warranty or performance terms so you know what is being projected."

Objection: "I heard solar is a scam."

Do not argue with rumors. Reframe from industry reputation to company process and transparent documentation.

"There are definitely bad actors in every industry. That is why we slow down, show the documents, explain the numbers, and make sure you know who is responsible for each step."

Objection: "I do not want a credit check."

Reframe as permission-based qualification. Do not run anything without clear authorization.

"That is completely your choice. The reason it comes up is that financing approval determines the exact option. We only do it with your permission, and I can explain what kind of check it is before anything happens."

Objection: "Rates might change later."

Reframe uncertainty both ways. Utility rates can change, program terms can change, and assumptions should be clear.

"True. That is why we compare what is known today and use conservative assumptions. The question is which path gives you more predictability."

Objection: "I want to wait."

Waiting feels safe because it avoids action. Reframe by naming the cost of waiting without fake urgency.

"Waiting is an option. The only thing I would compare is what waiting costs if your utility bill continues and the current program terms change. If waiting still makes more sense after that, then waiting is the right call."

Advanced Reframes by Emotional State

When the homeowner is confused

Confusion is not a no. It is a request for structure. Slow down and create a map.

"Let me simplify this. There are only three things to understand: what you pay now, what the solar option would be, and what has to happen for the system to turn on."

When the homeowner is defensive

Defensiveness usually means they feel sold, judged, or trapped. Rebuild safety.

"I may have moved too fast. Let us pause. My job is not to push you; it is to make sure you understand the option."

When the homeowner is skeptical

Skepticism can be healthy. Reframe it as good decision-making.

"I like that you are asking that. The people who ask detailed questions usually make the best decisions."

When the homeowner is excited

Excitement can close, but it can also create later remorse if details are skipped. Reframe excitement into informed confidence.

"I am glad you like the idea. Let us still walk through the important details so you feel good about it tomorrow too."

When the homeowner is silent

Silence is data. Do not fill it too quickly. Ask gently.

"What is going through your mind right now?"

The Language of a Master Framer

Use words that lower resistance

- "Option" instead of "deal"
- "Compare" instead of "convince"
- "Qualify" instead of "buy"
- "Next step" instead of "sign up"
- "More predictable" instead of "guaranteed" unless the agreement truly guarantees it
- "No upfront out-of-pocket cost" instead of "free" when accurate
- "Based on today's numbers" instead of overpromising future savings

Avoid words that create resistance

- "Contract" too early, before context
- "Close" in front of the homeowner
- "Trust me"
- "Everybody qualifies"
- "Guaranteed savings" unless legally and contractually true
- "This price is only good right now" unless that is documented and accurate

How to Frame the Three-Step Process

The original playbook uses a three-step structure. Here is the advanced version.

Step 1: "We learn the current situation."

"First, I want to understand what you are paying and how the home uses energy."

Step 2: "We check what the home may qualify for."

"Second, we check whether the roof, usage, and program fit the home."

Step 3: "We compare the current path with the solar path."

"Third, we compare both options side by side. If solar is not clearly better, we do not force it."

This frame is powerful because it makes you look patient, organized, and fair. The homeowner hears, "This person is not trying to trap me. They are helping me compare."

How to Reframe Utility Pain Without Sounding Negative

Do not attack the utility company emotionally. The point is not to create anger; it is to create awareness. Stick to the structure: current payment, lack of ownership, rate uncertainty, and comparison.

"The utility is not evil. It is just the current system. You pay every month, the rate can change, and there is no ownership at the end. Solar is worth checking because it may give you a lower and more predictable structure."

This is cleaner than saying, "The utility is robbing you." Strong framers do not need cartoon villains. They make the math visible.

How to Frame Credibility

Credibility should be casual, verified, and relevant. If you overdo credibility, it sounds like a pitch. If you underdo it, the homeowner may not understand that solar is mainstream.

The credibility triangle

- Local relevance: homes, communities, or city examples nearby.
- Institutional proof: companies, builders, or public facilities using solar.
- Legal/program proof: rights, incentives, utility rules, or net metering details, verified before use.

"The reason I mention those examples is not to say you should do it because others did. It is to show this is not experimental anymore. The real question is whether it fits your house and your numbers."

How to Frame the Application

The application should not feel like a trap. It should feel like a qualification step. Explain what information is used, why it is needed, and what happens next.

"The application tells us what option you qualify for. Before we submit anything, I want you to know what it checks, what it does not check, and what the result means."

If credit is involved, be transparent. A homeowner who feels surprised by a credit step may lose trust immediately.

How to Frame Documents and Signing

The signing moment is where many deals become fragile. The wrong frame is, "Tap here quickly." The right frame is, "Review this, understand it, and ask me questions before you sign."

"These documents put the program details in writing. I will show you where the key terms are: payment, system details, cancellation terms, installation process, and responsibilities. Ask me anything before you tap."

After they sign, reinforce the meaning of the decision and next steps. This reduces regret.

"Good. The next step is not installation tomorrow. The next step is the site survey and engineering review to confirm the final design."

Tone, Pace, and Silence

Tone

Tone tells the homeowner how to feel about the information. If you sound rushed, the information feels risky. If you sound calm, the information feels manageable.

- Use warm energy at the beginning.
- Use curiosity during discovery.
- Use calm seriousness when discussing money and documents.
- Use certainty only when you are certain.

Pace

Move faster through rapport and simple setup. Slow down around price, credit, documents, roof, timeline, warranties, and anything that creates obligation.

Silence

Silence is a tool. After asking a decision question, stop talking. After giving a reframe, let it land. After showing numbers, give them space to process.

Ask the question, then count silently: one, two, three, four. Do not rescue them from thinking.

The Reframe Library: Better Ways to Say Hard Things

Instead of: "You are already paying FPL forever."

Say: "Right now the utility bill has no end date. Solar is worth comparing because it may create a more predictable path."

Instead of: "This is a no-brainer."

Say: "If the numbers are lower, the terms are clear, and the home qualifies, it becomes a very practical decision."

Instead of: "You need to sign today."

Say: "If everything is clear and the numbers work, the next step today would be starting the formal review process."

Instead of: "Do not worry about that."

Say: "That matters. Let us look at it directly."

Instead of: "Everyone gets approved."

Say: "Approval depends on the application and home details. Let us check before assuming."

Instead of: "It is free."

Say: "There may be no upfront out-of-pocket cost if you qualify, but it is not free. We compare the payment and terms against your current bill."

Framing the A/B/C Close

The original playbook asks whether the homeowner cares most about savings, equity, or environment. This is strong because it lets the homeowner choose the meaning of the decision. The advanced move is to let their answer become the frame for the close.

If they choose savings

Frame the decision as predictability and monthly improvement.

"Then the main question is simple: can we lower what you pay and make it more predictable? If yes, that directly matches your reason."

If they choose home value or ownership

Frame the decision as control and long-term usefulness.

"Then the question is whether it makes sense to keep renting power from the utility or move toward more control over something your home uses every day."

If they choose environment

Frame the decision as impact without sacrifice, if the numbers work.

"Then the best version of this is when you can do the cleaner thing and still make the numbers work for the house."

The Master Close Structure

A clean close has five pieces: summarize, confirm value, confirm concerns, ask conditionally, and define the next step.

1. Summarize

"So your bill is around [amount], your main reason is [reason], and the concern we handled was [concern]."

2. Confirm value

"If the option comes back around [amount] and the terms are as explained, that is better than the current path, correct?"

3. Confirm concerns

"Before I ask about the next step, is there anything still unclear?"

4. Ask conditionally

"If the home qualifies and those numbers are confirmed, would you be comfortable moving forward?"

5. Define next step

"The next step would be starting the paperwork so engineering and the utility process can begin. I will walk you through it slowly."

Field Mistakes That Destroy Frames

- Answering objections before fully understanding them.
- Talking about panels before framing the utility comparison.
- Using fake urgency.
- Calling the program free.
- Skipping the spouse or decision-maker.
- Rushing DocuSign.
- Overloading the homeowner with technical terms.
- Letting the homeowner control the sequence before you explain the map.
- Arguing with skepticism instead of validating it.
- Trying to close before the homeowner can explain the value in their own words.

The Master Discovery Grid

Use this grid when you feel resistance. It helps you locate the real objection.

Money

"Is the concern the monthly number, the total amount, or whether the savings are real?"

Trust

"Is the concern solar in general, our company, the lender, or something you heard before?"

Timing

"Is this a bad time because of the decision, the installation, or other priorities?"

Authority

"Who else would want to understand this before you feel comfortable?"

Risk

"Is the concern the roof, warranty, production, moving, cancellation, or something else?"

Understanding

"Which part feels least clear right now?"

Once you identify the category, reframe that category. Do not throw random answers at a hidden concern.

Practice Drills

Drill 1: The Comparison Drill

Take every price objection and answer with a comparison question.

Homeowner: "That is expensive." Rep: "Compared to your current bill, the total cost, or another quote?"

Drill 2: The Meaning Drill

For every homeowner statement, identify the meaning they attached to it.

"I need to think" may mean: unclear, unsafe, missing spouse, distrust, price fear, or decision fatigue.

Drill 3: The One-Sentence Reframe

Practice turning long explanations into one clean sentence.

"The goal is not to add a bill; it is to replace the bill you already have with a better option if you qualify."

Drill 4: The Silence Drill

Ask a closing question and stay silent for four seconds. This builds control and prevents nervous overtalking.

Drill 5: The Objection Ladder

Ask "What else?" until the homeowner says there is nothing else. Then handle concerns one by one.

"Got it. What else?" "Anything else?" "If we handle those two, would you feel clear?"

Rep Self-Scorecard

After every consultation, score yourself from 1 to 5.

- Did I set a clear agenda?
- Did I build real rapport without wasting time?
- Did I frame the utility comparison clearly?
- Did I avoid exaggerated or unverified claims?
- Did I ask for all concerns before answering?
- Did I identify the homeowner's main motivation?
- Did I use the right close path?
- Did I slow down around documents?
- Did the homeowner understand the next steps?
- Did I leave the homeowner more certain, not more pressured?

The Field Cheat Sheet

Opening frame

"I will keep this simple: check usage, explain the program, compare numbers. If it fits, great. If not, no pressure."

Utility reframe

"Doing nothing still means continuing the utility bill with no fixed end date."

Price reframe

"Let us compare it to what you already pay, not to zero."

Free reframe

"Not free. Possibly no upfront out-of-pocket cost if you qualify."

Think-about-it reframe

"Usually that means one part is still unclear. Which part?"

Spouse reframe

"They should be included. Let us make sure the information is clear so you can both decide."

Document frame

"These documents put the details in writing. Let us review the key terms before you sign."

Hesitation frame

"Let us pause. I want you completely comfortable. What is still on your mind?"

Final Philosophy

After forty years of perfecting framing, the lesson would not be that people are easy to manipulate. The lesson would be the opposite: people are complex, protective, emotional, logical, distracted, hopeful, and afraid of being wrong. Framing works because it respects how decisions are actually made.

The master framer does not overpower the homeowner. The master framer organizes the conversation so the homeowner can see clearly. The close is not the moment you defeat resistance. It is the moment clarity becomes strong enough to act.

The highest-level frame: "I am here to help you make the best decision with the clearest information." If every word supports that frame, you will sell with power and sleep with peace.